

A night-time photograph of the Paris skyline, featuring the Eiffel Tower and other illuminated buildings reflected in the water of the Seine River. The sky is a deep blue with some clouds.

A LOCAL-LIVING GUIDE

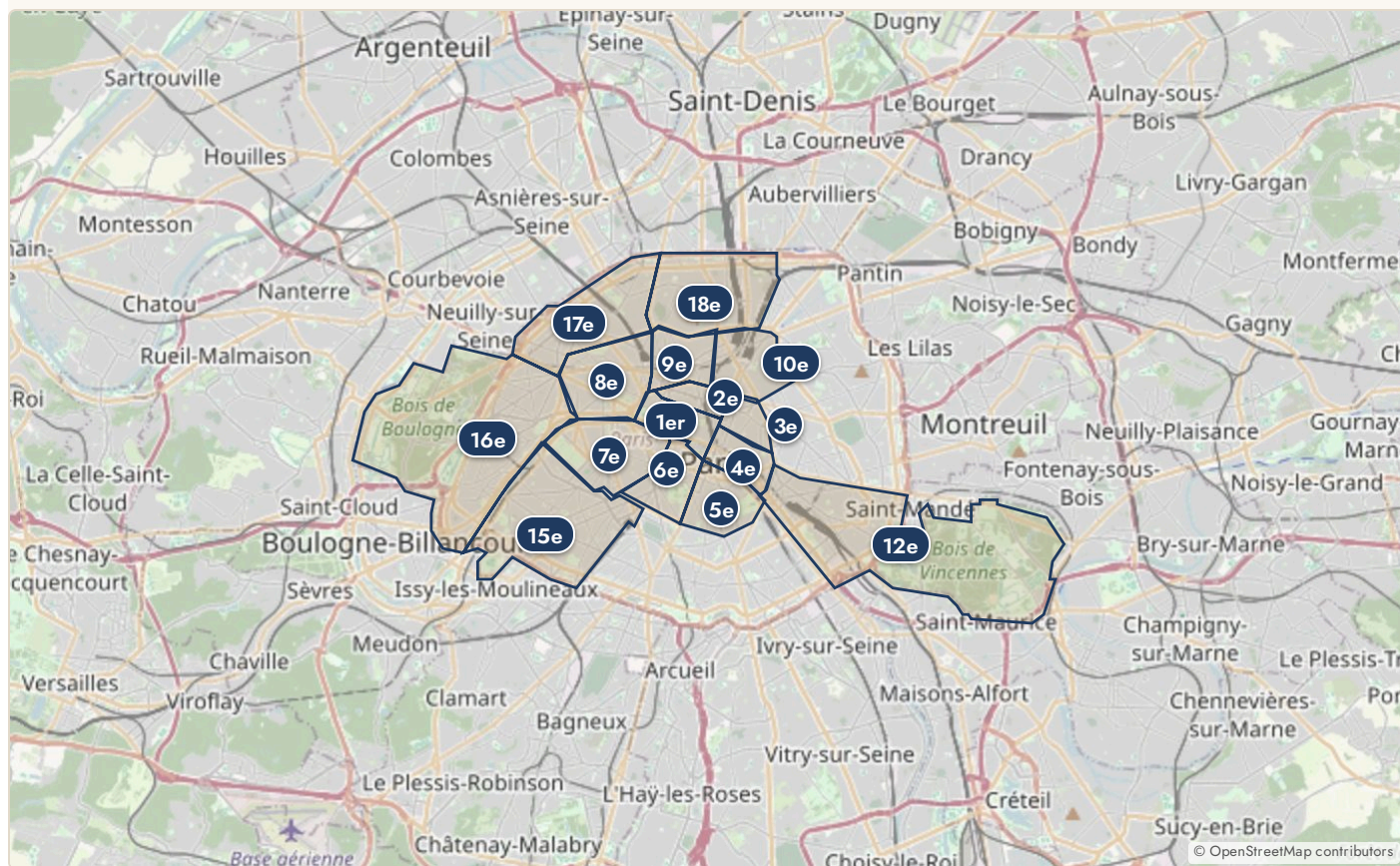
Paris, *arrondissement* by arrondissement

Cafés, markets, restaurants, shopping, walks and sights for a month of living in Paris — not just visiting it. Built for the Paris + Rail Extensions trip.

ANDREW & SYLVAIN · EDITION OF SEPTEMBER 2026

The neighbourhoods

Paris's 20 arrondissements spiral out clockwise from the Louvre like a snail shell. Shaded below are the ones this guide covers; each chapter opens with its own street map, and every numbered bubble matches a numbered entry in the listings.



• Before you go: museums, closures & tips

• Getting around: the Métro in 2026

• LGBTQ+ Paris

1er Louvre & Palais-Royal

2e Bourse & the Covered Passages

3e · 4e Le Marais & the Islands

5e Latin Quarter

6e Saint-Germain-des-Prés

7e Eiffel Tower, Invalides & Orsay

8e Champs-Élysées & Monceau

9e · 17e Opéra, Nouvelle-Athènes & Wagram

10e Canal Saint-Martin

12e Aligre

15e Rue du Commerce

16e Passy, Auteuil & Trocadéro

18e Montmartre

• Walk: Boulevard Saint-Germain

• Musée d'Orsay: 15 masterpieces

• Museum cafés at a glance

• Walk: the Petite Ceinture

• Choosing your home base

• Day trips & rail extensions

• Sources & photo credits

Museums, closures & good habits

Paris Museum Pass

Recommended for a first visit — skip-the-line entry to 50+ museums and monuments. Buy online in advance or at the first museum you visit. (Reservations are still needed at the Louvre and Orsay.)

Plan around closures

Many museums close Monday or Tuesday: Louvre & Orangerie close Tuesdays; Orsay, Rodin & Marmottan close Mondays. The Marché Beauvau covered market is closed Mondays.

Pair Orangerie + Orsay

They face each other across the Seine — do both on the same day.

Self-guided highlights

If you're not booking a guided tour, Rick Steves' free museum highlight audio tours (Rick Steves Audio Europe app) cover the Louvre, Orsay and more without overwhelm.

Late openings

Orsay Thursdays until 9:45 pm; Orangerie Fridays until 9 pm during *Monet, Painting Time* (reduced price from 6 pm).



Monet, *Water Lilies* — Claude Monet · Public domain

This autumn: *Monet, Painting Time* at the Orangerie, 30 Sept 2026 – 25 Jan 2027. Fridays to 9 pm, reduced entry after 6 pm.



Benh LIEU SONG (Flickr) · CC BY-SA 4.0

The Métro in 2026

Paper tickets are gone

Since late 2025 you need a **Navigo Easy** card (€2, reloadable at machines) or the **Île-de-France Mobilités app** (tickets on your phone; Apple/Google Pay). You can't tap a bank card at the gates.

One card each

Every traveller needs their own card or phone. No senior discount for visitors.

Hours

About 5:30 am to 1 am weekdays, 2 am Fri–Sat; Noctilien night buses after.

Fares (2026)

Single ride €2.55 (bus/tram too) · Day pass €12.30 · **Navigo Semaine** weekly €32.40 (Mon–Sun only — great for a month-long stay, buy a new week each Monday) · Airport (CDG/Orly) €14.

How to ride

Tap the card on the reader before the turnstile and wait for the beep. Phone tickets still validate for a while if your battery dies.

Safety

Safe day and night; mind your bag and phone near doors on Lines 1, 4 and the RER.



Guimard's Porte Dauphine entrance — Bellomonte · CCO

LGBTQ+ Paris

The climate

One of Europe's most relaxed cities for gay travellers: same-sex marriage has been legal in France since 2013, and holding hands in the Marais, Saint-Germain or Montmartre draws no second look. Usual big-city awareness late at night.

Pride

The Marche des Fiertés normally falls on the last Saturday of June and closes two weeks of events (the Quinzaine des Fiertés). In 2026 it was moved to **Saturday 3 October** (Place d'Italie → Bastille, 1 pm); the 2027 date is not yet announced.

A queer-history walk

Start at the rainbow crossings of Place Harvey-Milk, see the Lenoir & Diot plaques on Rue Montorgueil, then take the Métro to Père-Lachaise for Oscar Wilde's tomb.

The Marais

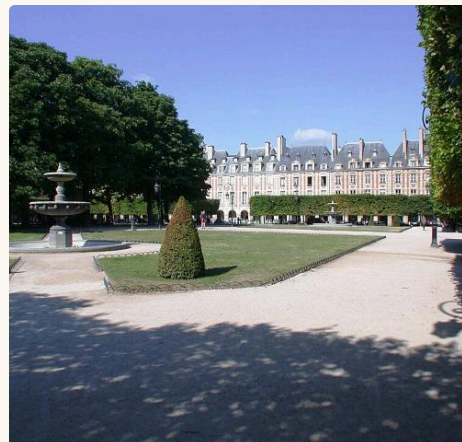
Paris's gay village since Le Village bar opened on Rue du Plâtre in 1978. Most bars are on Rue des Archives, Rue Vieille-du-Temple and Rue Sainte-Croix-de-la-Bretonnerie; the scene also spreads to Pigalle (Madame Arthur) and Belleville.

Books & community

Les Mots à la Bouche, Paris's LGBTQ+ bookshop since 1980, is now at 37 Rue Saint-Ambroise (11e). The Centre LGBTQI+ (63 Rue Beaubourg) has the largest LGBTQI+ library in France and the month's event listings.

Sunday afternoons

Rosa Bonheur in the Buttes-Chaumont park (19e) — a hilltop guinguette with a legendary Sunday crowd; its barge sister is by the Invalides.

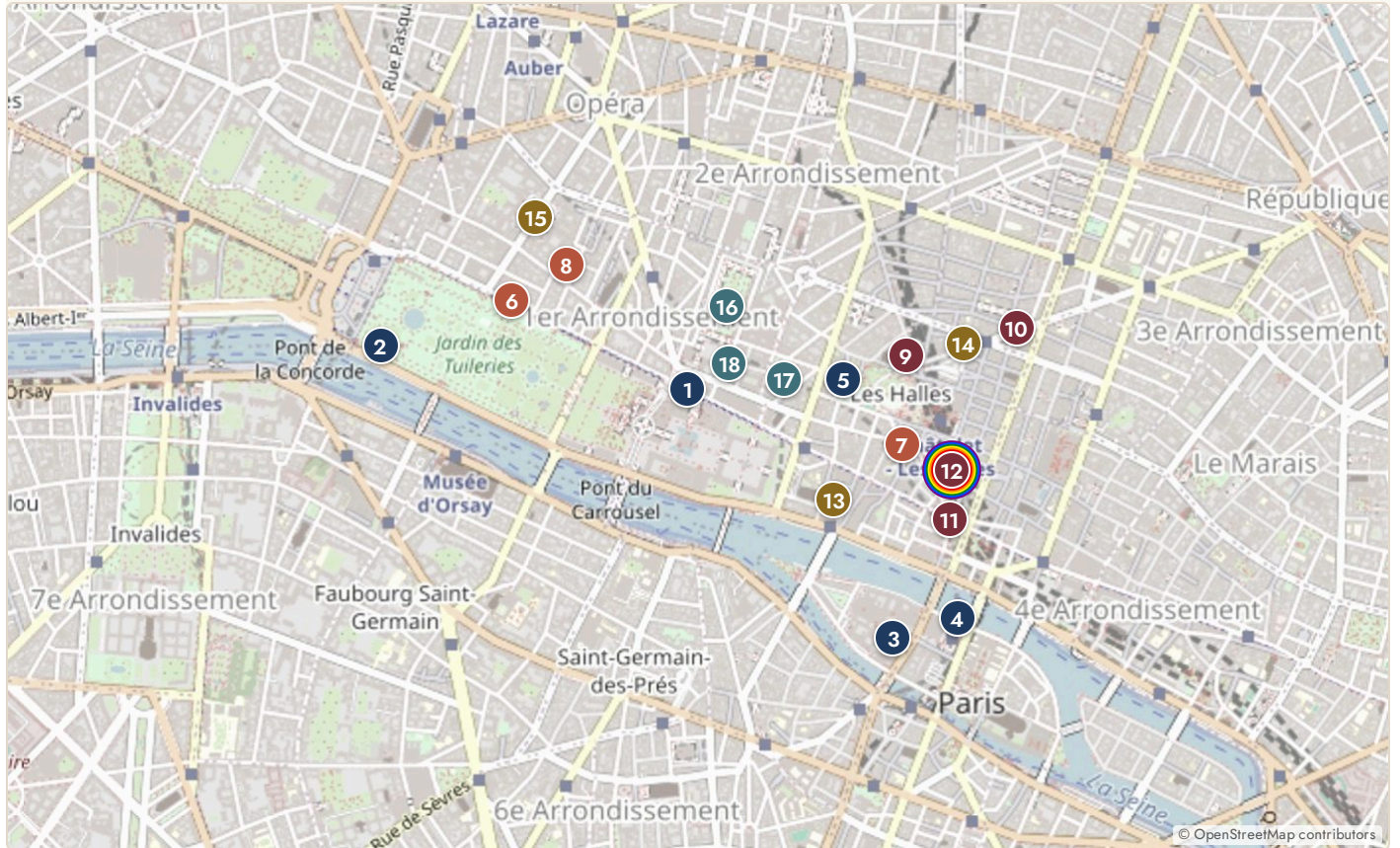


Place des Vosges, Le Marais — User: (WT-shared) Riggwelter at wts wikivoyage · CC BY-SA 4.0

Throughout this guide, the  badge and rainbow-ringed map pins mark gay and LGBTQ+-friendly places.

1er Louvre & Palais-Royal

The historic dead centre of Paris: grand, monumental and touristy near the Louvre, but quieter and more residential the further you drift from Rue de Rivoli.



● Sights & Museums ● Cafés & Sweets ● Restaurants & Bars ● Markets & Food Shops ● Shopping ● Walks & Hidden Corners ● LGBTQ+-friendly

SIGHTS & MUSEUMS

- 1 **Musée du Louvre** — Go early or late and don't try to see it all — pick a wing. Covered by the Paris Museum Pass; closed Tuesdays.
- 2 **Musée de l'Orangerie** NEW — Monet's *Water Lilies* in the two oval rooms built for them (installed 17 May 1927, months after his death). **New: Monet, Painting Time**, 30 Sept 2026 – 25 Jan 2027 — nearly 40 paintings on light, repeated subjects and the late Water Lilies, marking 100 years since his death. Open until 9 pm Fridays during the show, reduced admission from 6 pm. Closed Tuesdays. Pair it with the Musée d'Orsay across the river on the same day.
- 3 **Sainte-Chapelle** — Go for the upper chapel's wall of 13th-century stained glass — best on a sunny morning.

- 4 **Conciergerie** — Marie Antoinette's prison; far fewer crowds than the big sights.
- 5 **Bourse de Commerce – Pinault Collection** — Contemporary art under a beautiful restored dome.



Guilhem Vellut from Paris, France · CC BY 2.0

CAFÉS & SWEETS

- 6 **Angelina** — The famous thick hot chocolate.

- 7 **Café Saint Honoré** — One of the prettiest cafés in the 1st — green-and-pink façade, flowers spilling from the ceiling. Reserve in busy periods.
- 8 **Jean-Paul Hévin** — Handmade chocolates.

RESTAURANTS & BARS

- 9 **Au Pied de Cochon** — Classic brasserie, pork and seafood, open very late.
- 10 **Poulette** — Tiled walls, inventive takes on the classics, near Châtelet.
- 11 **Chouchou** — French classics with North African flavours; live music some evenings — good before a jazz club.
- 12 **Banana Café**  — Gay institution near Châtelet for cabaret, karaoke and a terrace — open until dawn.



Gerda Arendt · CC0

SHOPPING

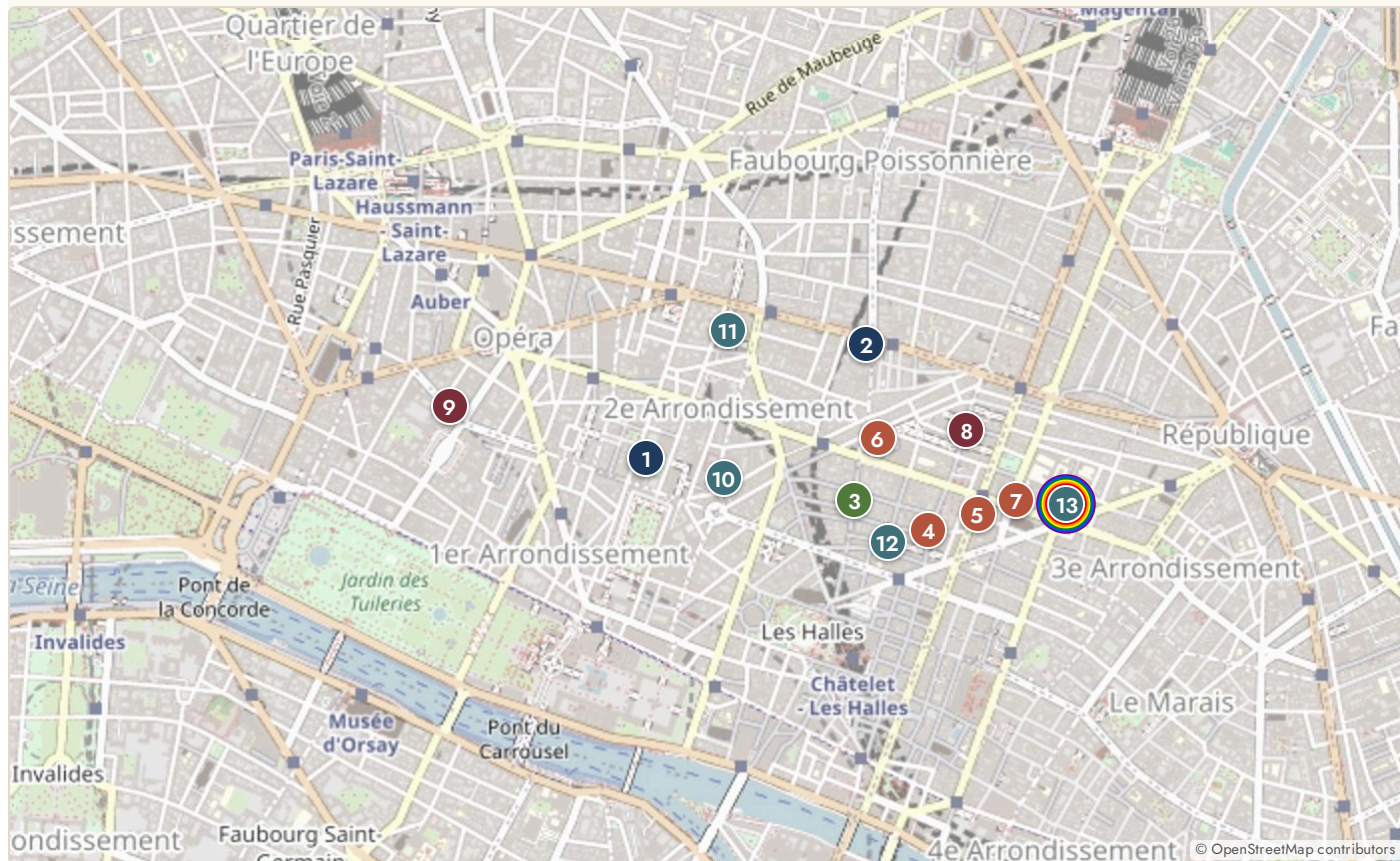
- 13 **La Samaritaine** — Restored Art Nouveau / Art Deco department store — worth a look even without buying.
- 14 **E. Dehillerin** — Julia Child's old cookware haunt for proper French kitchen gear.
- 15 **Place Vendôme & Rue de Rivoli** — High jewellery on the square; souvenir shops and upscale boutiques under the Rivoli arcades.

WALKS & HIDDEN CORNERS

- 16 **Jardins du Palais-Royal** — The locals' Tuileries — arcaded walkways, the striped Buren columns, green café chairs, far fewer tourists.
- 17 **Galerie Véro-Dodat** — Beautifully preserved 1826 covered passage with a checkerboard floor, one of the few in the 1st.
- 18 **Kiosque des Noctambules** — Whimsical glass-bead Métro entrance at Palais-Royal–Musée du Louvre. (The Louvre–Rivoli platform also has replica Louvre sculptures.)

2e Bourse & the Covered Passages

The smallest and least-touristed central arrondissement — no headline landmarks, but the best-preserved covered passages in the city and a real everyday market street.



● Sights & Museums ● Cafés & Sweets ● Restaurants & Bars ● Markets & Food Shops ● Shopping ● Walks & Hidden Corners ● LGBTQ+-friendly

SIGHTS & MUSEUMS

- 1 **BnF Richelieu – Salle Ovale** — Free, and one of the most beautiful public rooms in Paris. Walk the perimeter even if you don't sit to read.
- 2 **Le Grand Rex** — Art Deco landmark and Europe's largest cinema; runs backstage tours.



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MARKETS & FOOD SHOPS

- 3 **Rue Montorgueil** — Pedestrian market street — boulangeries, fromageries, butchers, chocolatiers, fruit stands. Your everyday shopping street if staying nearby.

CAFÉS & SWEETS

- 4 **Stohrer** — Oldest pâtisserie in Paris (1730); the baba au rhum was invented here. Look up at the painted ceiling.
- 5 **À la Mère de Famille** — Historic chocolate and confectionery shop.
- 6 **Plaq** — Serious bean-to-bar chocolatier with excellent hot chocolate.
- 7 **Florida** — Scarlet, flower-covered façade, three wrapped terraces and a Belle Époque interior; heated year-round.



Jean-Pierre Dalbéra · CC BY 2.0

RESTAURANTS & BARS

- 8 **Brasserie Dubillot** — Bright mid-century room (2021) with what many call the best French onion soup in Paris. Walk-ins only — arrive early.
- **Le Chardonnay** — Outstanding truffle croque monsieur.
- 9 **Le Petit Vendôme** — Steak au poivre, and a popular lunchtime sandwich counter.

SHOPPING

- **Covered-passage boutiques** — Antique books, prints, stamps and toys in Vivienne, Panoramas and Grand Cerf.

WALKS & HIDDEN CORNERS

- 10 **Galerie Vivienne** — Mosaic floors, antique bookshops, boutiques and tearooms.
- 11 **Passage des Panoramas** — Oldest covered passage in Paris (1799); also home to Les Saveurs de l'Orient.
- 12 **Passage du Grand Cerf** — Tall glass-roofed passage with design shops; the quieter Passage Bourg-l'Abbé is next door.
- 13 **Plaques to Bruno Lenoir & Jean Diot**  — Pavement plaques on Rue Montorgueil mark where the two men were arrested in January 1750; executed that July, they were the last people put to death in France for homosexuality. Unveiled in 2014.

3e · 4e Le Marais & the Islands

Medieval lanes, hidden courtyards, food markets and boutique shopping — the neighbourhood that best matches “food, markets and wandering,” and a leading home-base candidate. It has also been Paris's gay village since the late 1970s — look for the rainbow-marked places below.



SIGHTS & MUSEUMS

- 1 **Notre-Dame de Paris** — Reopened December 2024 after the fire restoration. Free to enter; book the towers ahead.
- 2 **Place des Vosges** — Oldest planned square in Paris — arcaded red-brick houses around a park.
- 3 **Musée Carnavalet** NEW — The museum of Paris's own history — free and excellent. Its **Joli Café** sits in a courtyard garden of sculpted hedges; no ticket needed, book ahead for meals.
- 4 **Musée Picasso** — In the grand Hôtel Salé.
- 5 **Maison de Victor Hugo** — His apartment overlooking Place des Vosges.

- 6 **Centre Pompidou** — Closed for renovation until 2030 — skip this trip.
- 7 **Centre LGBTQI+ de Paris** LGBTQ+ — France's largest LGBTQI+ library, event listings and a welcoming café-bar with solidarity prices. Welcome desk Mon–Fri 3–8 pm, Sat 1–7 pm.



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MARKETS & FOOD SHOPS

- 8 **Marché des Enfants Rouges** — Oldest covered food market in Paris (1615) — half produce, half food court. Chez Alain Miam Miam for sandwiches, The Butcher of Paris for charcuterie.
- 9 **Marché aux Fleurs** — Flower market on Île de la Cité — lovely to walk through.

CAFÉS & SWEETS

- 10 **Berthillon** — Île Saint-Louis's ice-cream institution.
- 11 **Carette (Place des Vosges)** — Hot chocolate under an enormous mound of whipped cream.
- 12 **Maison Georges Larnicol** — Kouign-amann.
- 13 **Le Saint Régis** — Corner café on Île Saint-Louis — green-and-cream front, checkerboard floors; calm breakfast away from the Notre-Dame crowds.
- 14 **Café Blanchet** — Flower-covered façade, resident cat, honest prices, continuous service.
- 15 **Au Petit Versailles du Marais** — Classic French bakery in a listed shopfront.
- 16 **Les Marronniers**  — Café-brasserie with a big people-watching terrace in the heart of the gay Marais — brunch, lunch or a famous hot chocolate.



Popolon · CC BY-SA 3.0

RESTAURANTS & BARS

- 17 **L'As du Falafel** — No-frills and excellent.
- 18 **Bistrot des Tournelles** — Traditional bistro classics.
- 19 **Cox**  — The Marais' landmark gay bar on the Harvey-Milk corner; the crowd spills onto the pavement during happy hour (until 10 pm).
- 20 **Le Duplex**  — Since 1980: an artsy, conversational bar with art on the walls and an eclectic playlist — an easy first drink.
- 21 **Freedj**  — Lively bar with a small basement dance floor Friday to Sunday; a 30s-and-up crowd.

- 22 **One Way**  — Friendly neighbourhood bar for bears and a 40s-plus crowd; happy hour 7–9 pm.
- 23 **Le Ju'**  — Colourful, rainbow-touched brasserie for brunch, drinks or an easy dinner.
- 24 **Le Tango – La Boîte à Frissons**  — A 19th-century bal-musette turned LGBTQ+ dance hall, saved by the City and reopened as a cooperative in 2023: waltz, Dalida and disco. Sunday 7–11:30 pm is the gentlest night; Fri–Sat until 5 am.

SHOPPING

- 25 **Rue des Francs-Bourgeois & Rue Vieille-du-Temple**  — Concept shops, vintage racks and jewellers in centuries-old buildings; French brands such as Diptyque, Caudalie, Maje and Sandro. Avoid Sundays — very crowded.

WALKS & HIDDEN CORNERS

- 26 **Rue François-Miron (nos. 11 & 13)** — Two genuinely medieval half-timbered houses — rare in Paris.
- 27 **Passage de l'Ancre** — Oldest covered passage in the city, now a quiet, garden-like residential corner.
- 28 **Tour Saint-Jacques** — Gothic tower most people walk past; climbable May–November with views to Notre-Dame and the Eiffel Tower.
- 29 **Place Harvey-Milk & the rainbow crossings**  — The heart of the gay Marais, where Rue des Archives meets Rue de la Verrerie. The rainbow crosswalks were made permanent after homophobic vandalism in 2018, and the square was named for the San Francisco gay-rights pioneer in 2019.

5^e Latin Quarter

The oldest part of Paris (Roman Lutetia) — old bookshops, cheap professor-filled bistros and a lived-in feel. The *Life in Rural France* author's personal favourite.



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SIGHTS & MUSEUMS

- 1 **Panthéon** — Crypts hold Voltaire, Rousseau, Marie Curie, Victor Hugo and Dumas.
- 2 **Saint-Étienne-du-Mont** — The only surviving rood screen (jubé) in Paris — an ornate 1530s stone gallery over the nave.
- 3 **Musée de Cluny** — Built into Roman bath ruins; the *Lady and the Unicorn* tapestries upstairs.
- 4 **Jardin des Plantes** — The botanical garden — beautiful in spring.
- 5 **Arènes de Lutèce** — 1st-century Roman amphitheatre where locals now play pétanque.

- 6 **Grande Mosquée de Paris** — 1920s Neo-Moorish mosque, Andalusian garden and a tearoom for mint tea and pastries.
- 7 **Institut du Monde Arabe** — Free rooftop terrace with one of the best under-the-radar views; the south façade's 240 camera-iris apertures open and close with the light.
- 8 **Musée Curie** — Small, free, in her actual former lab.



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MARKETS & FOOD SHOPS

- 9 **Rue Mouffetard** — The 5th's market street. Best 10 am–1 pm, especially Saturdays; closed Sunday afternoon and Monday. Start at Square Saint-Médard and walk north.
- 10 **Marché Place Monge** — Wed / Fri / Sun, 7 am–2:30 pm — a more local alternative.

CAFÉS & SWEETS

- 11 **A. Lacroix Pâtissier** — Lifelike “fruit” pastries; good savoury lunch too.
- 12 **Odette** — Filled choux puffs.



Shadowgate from Novara, ITALY · CC BY 2.0

RESTAURANTS & BARS

- **Sorbonne bistros** — Cheap, cheerful, professor-filled bistros throughout the quarter.

SHOPPING

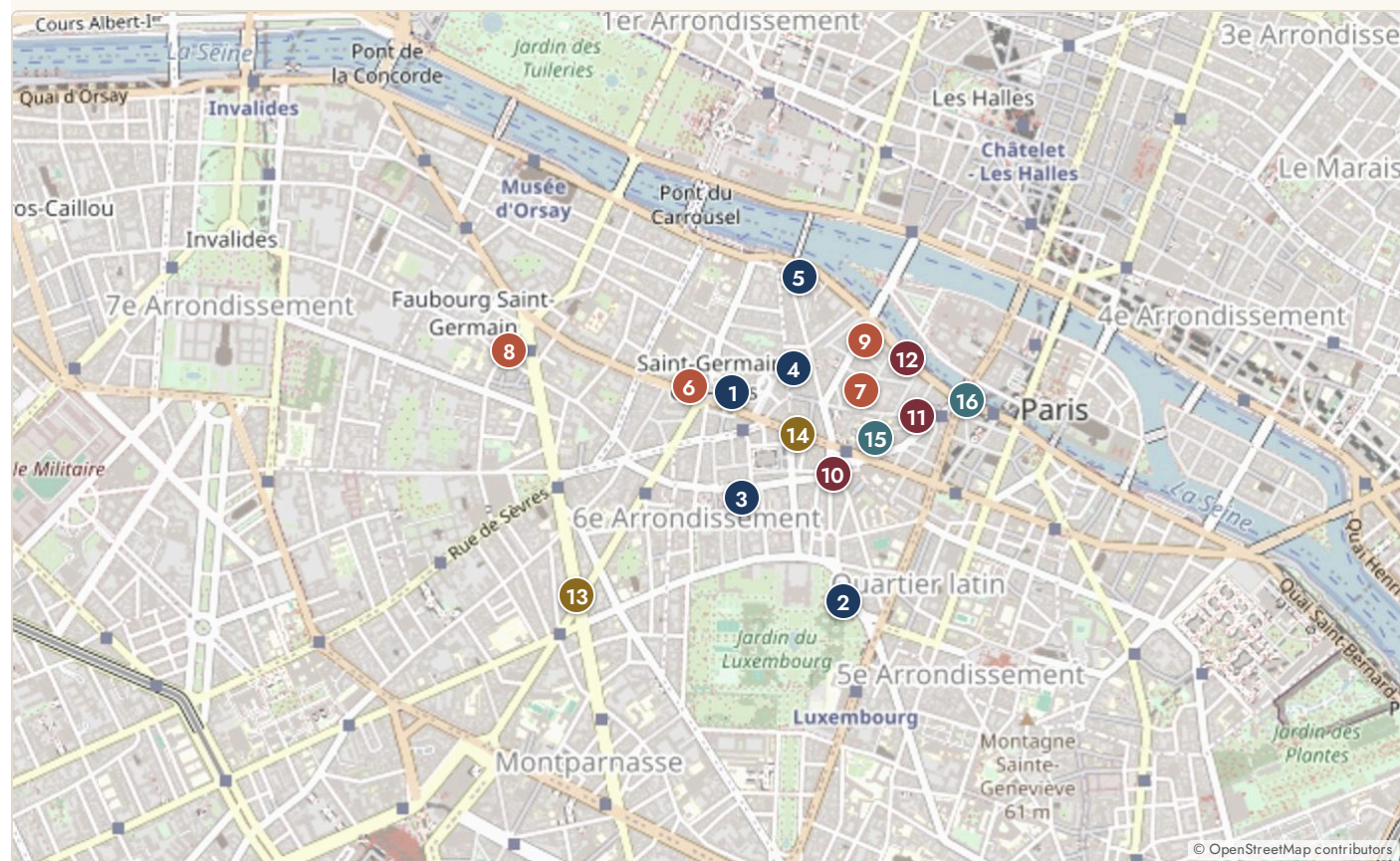
- 13 **Shakespeare and Company** — The famous English-language bookshop across from Notre-Dame — expect a line.
- 14 **The Abbey Bookshop** — Cramped, beloved, Canadian-run since 1989 — Canadian literature and philosophy.
- 15 **Bouquinistes** — Green book stalls along the Seine between Pont Neuf and Pont de la Tournelle (thin in winter).

WALKS & HIDDEN CORNERS

- 16 **Place de la Contrescarpe** — Social hub at the top of Mouffetard; Hemingway lived just off it (*A Moveable Feast*).
- 17 **Rue du Chat-qui-Pêche** — Narrowest street in Paris (1.8 m).
- 18 **Saint-Séverin & Rue de la Huchette** — Flamboyant Gothic church with a palm-tree pillar; nearby, the Caveau de la Huchette cellar jazz club, running since the 1940s.
- 19 **Place de la Sorbonne** — The university's home since 1257, ringed with bookshops and cafés.

6^e ARRONDISSEMENT Saint-Germain-des-Prés

The grown-up café-culture neighbourhood where Sartre, de Beauvoir and Hemingway held court — polished, central and bookish.



● Sights & Museums ● Cafés & Sweets ● Restaurants & Bars ● Markets & Food Shops ● Shopping ● Walks & Hidden Corners ● LGBTQ+-friendly

SIGHTS & MUSEUMS

- 1 **Église Saint-Germain-des-Prés** — One of the oldest churches in Paris, founded in 558 as the abbey that gave the district its name.
- 2 **Jardin du Luxembourg** — Arguably the best park in central Paris — the Medici Fountain, sailboats on the basin, a sightline to the Panthéon.
- 3 **Église Saint-Sulpice** — Second-largest church in Paris, with a spectacular Cavaillé-Coll organ.
- 4 **Musée Delacroix** — Small and low-key, in his former home and studio.
- 5 **Bibliothèque Mazarine** — Oldest public library in France (1643); free to walk through.



Arnaud 25 · Public domain

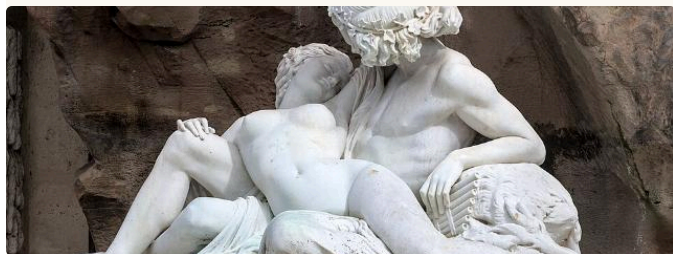
CAFÉS & SWEETS

- 6 **Café de Flore** — Pricy — you're paying for the setting and the ghosts. One coffee for the history.
- 7 **Les Deux Magots** — Directly opposite the Flore; the carved Chinese figures inside gave it its name.
- 8 **Chapon** — Chocolate mousse served in a paper cone.

- 9 **La Diva des Prés** — Huge display of pink silk roses around the entrance; best on a quiet weekday afternoon.

RESTAURANTS & BARS

- 10 **Breizh Café** — Breton buckwheat galettes.
- 11 **La Jacobine** — Coq au vin in the Cour du Commerce.
- 12 **Bistro des Augustins** — Facing the Seine; famous potato gratins.
- **Le Jardin Saint-Germain** — Confit de canard — book ahead.



Romainbehar · CCO

SHOPPING

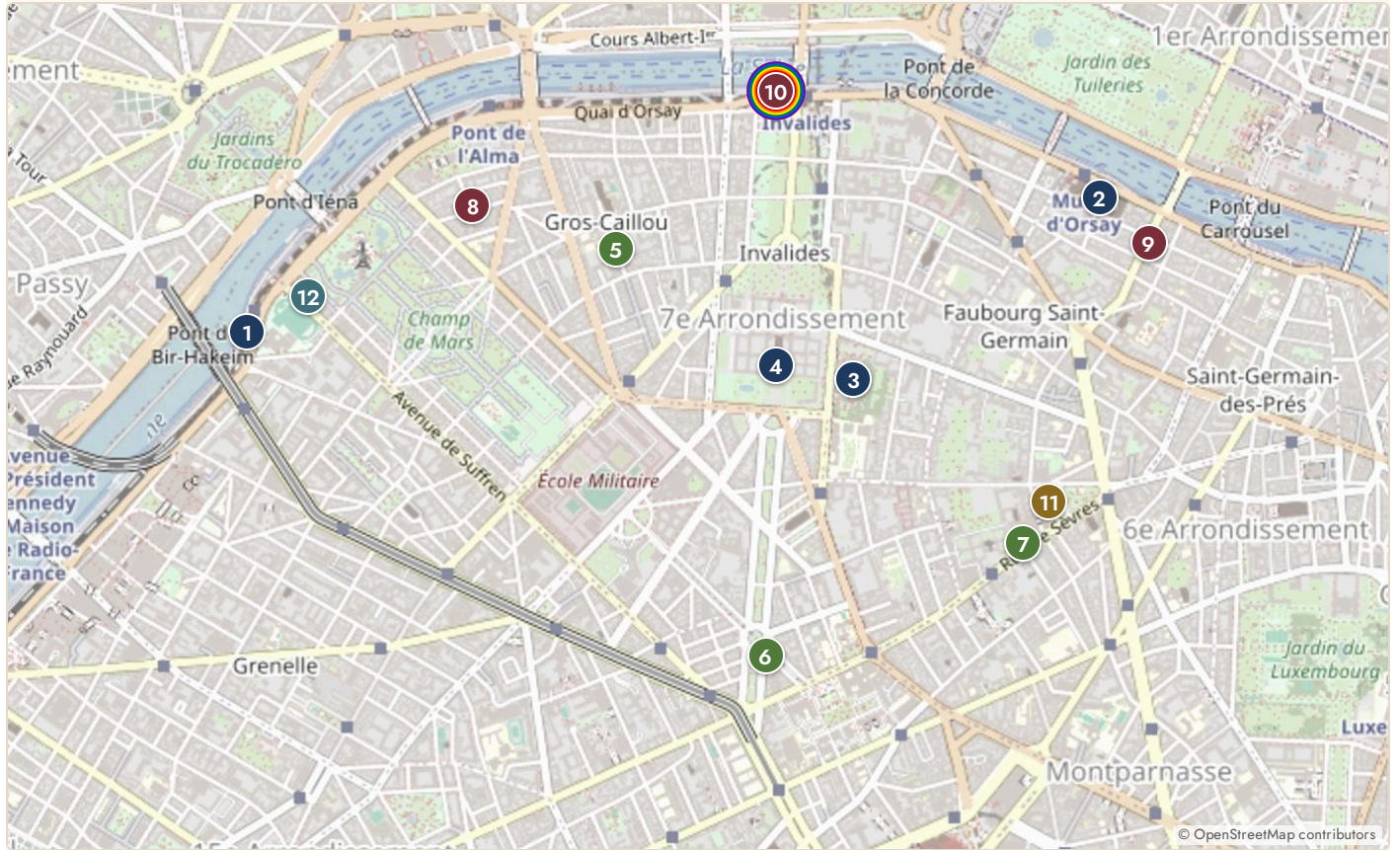
- 13 **Rue de Rennes** **NEW** — Tidy, practical shopping between Montparnasse and Saint-Germain: Maje, Sandro, Claudie Pierlot, Sephora, Uniqlo, FNAC.
- 14 **Boulevard Saint-Germain boutiques** — High concentration of bookshops and chocolatiers plus luxury houses — see the boulevard walk later in this guide.

WALKS & HIDDEN CORNERS

- 15 **Cour du Commerce Saint-André** — Little cobbled passage off the boulevard; home to Le Procope, often called the oldest restaurant in Paris.
- 16 **Rue de Buci** — 800-year-old street, narrow and lively with restaurants and bars.

7^e Eiffel Tower, Invalides & Orsay

Polished and residential — embassies, quiet streets and excellent museums a few blocks off the Champ de Mars.



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SIGHTS & MUSEUMS

- 1 **Tour Eiffel** — Book online; the 2nd level alone is worth it if short on time.
- 2 **Musée d'Orsay** NEW — World's greatest Impressionist collection in a former station (see the 15 masterpieces page). Cafés: **Café Campana** behind the giant clock face (5th floor), the gilded Belle Époque **Restaurant du Musée** (no reservations), a summer-only rooftop terrace — all need a museum ticket. Closed Mondays.
- 3 **Musée Rodin** — *The Thinker* and *The Kiss* in an 18th-century mansion and garden, with Eiffel Tower views through the trees.
- 4 **Les Invalides** — Napoleon's tomb under the gold dome.



Phyrexian · CC BY-SA 4.0

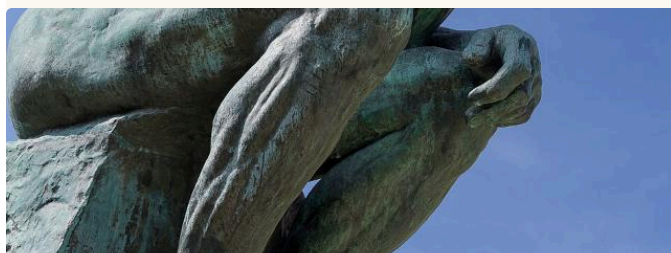
MARKETS & FOOD SHOPS

- 5 **Rue Cler** — Pedestrian market street — assemble a Champ de Mars picnic. Fromagerie Cantin and Fromagerie de Grenelle just off it.
- 6 **Marché Saxe-Breteuil** — Thu & Sat 7 am–2:30 pm, lined up on the Eiffel Tower — one of the most scenic markets in Paris.

- 7 **La Grande Épicerie de Paris** NEW — Since 1923 — the city's most prestigious food hall: produce, cheese, charcuterie, wine cellar, open kitchens. Eat at La Table, La Marée (seafood), La Truffe by Petrossian, or the casual Petite Sandwicherie. Mon–Sat 8:30 am–9 pm, Sun 10 am–8 pm. Great for gift butter, jams, tins.

CAFÉS & SWEETS

- **Maison Bergeron** — Boulangerie with hand-painted ceilings; viennoiseries and lunch sandwiches.



Douglas O'Brien from Canada · CC BY-SA 2.0

RESTAURANTS & BARS

- 8 **Au Bon Accueil** — Relaxed dinner with an Eiffel Tower view — reserve the terrace.
- 9 **Les Antiquaires** — Near Orsay; excellent bœuf bourguignon.
- 10 **Rosa Bonheur sur Seine** LGBTQ+ — LGBTQ+-favourite guinguette on a barge by the Invalides: tapas, drinks and dancing, year-round Wed–Sun (from noon at weekends). Its sister in the Buttes-Chaumont park (19e) is a Sunday-afternoon institution.

SHOPPING

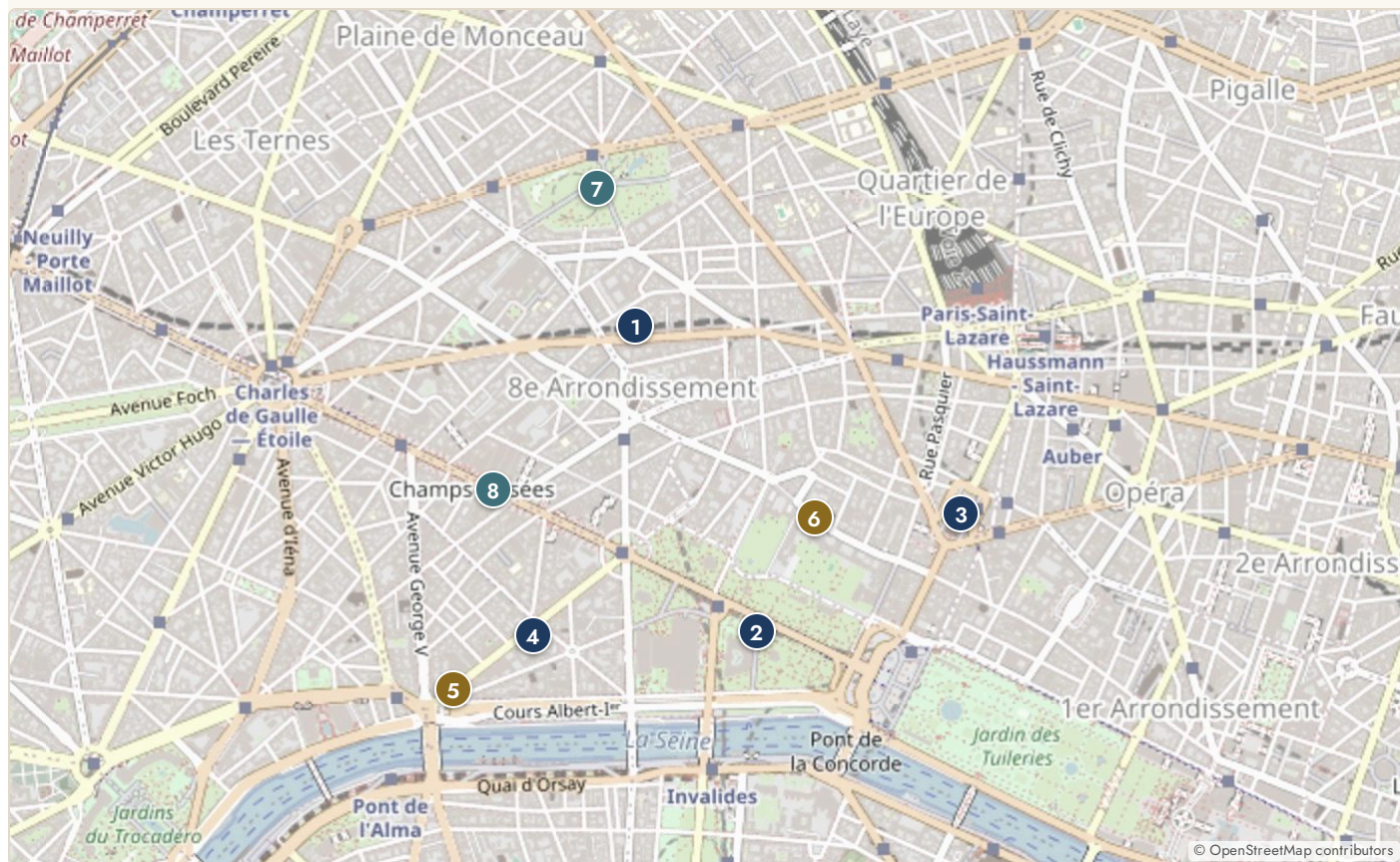
- 11 **Le Bon Marché** — Oldest department store in Paris and the only one on the Left Bank — calmer than the Opéra stores.

WALKS & HIDDEN CORNERS

- 12 **Eiffel viewpoints** — Rue de l'Université and Rue Buenos-Ayres frame the tower between Haussmann buildings; Place de Sydney and Avenue de Montessuy are quieter alternatives.

8e Arrondissement Champs-Élysées & Monceau

Monumental along the Champs-Élysées, quiet and residential a few blocks off it. Treat it as a sightseeing and shopping day; eat elsewhere.



● Sights & Museums ● Cafés & Sweets ● Restaurants & Bars ● Markets & Food Shops ● Shopping ● Walks & Hidden Corners ● LGBTQ+-friendly

SIGHTS & MUSEUMS

- 1 **Musée Jacquemart-André** — 19th-century private mansion — one of the best hidden-gem museums, often near-empty even in high season.
- 2 **Petit Palais** NEW — Free fine-arts museum (Monet, Cézanne, Rodin). **Café 1902** wraps the courtyard garden under a painted ceiling — take a gallery table; no ticket or booking needed.
- 3 **La Madeleine** — Greek temple outside, Baroque inside — far less crowded than Notre-Dame.
- 4 **La Galerie Dior** — Book weeks ahead; Café Dior inside.

SHOPPING

- 5 **The Golden Triangle** — Avenue Montaigne, Avenue George-V and the Champs-Élysées for couture flagships.

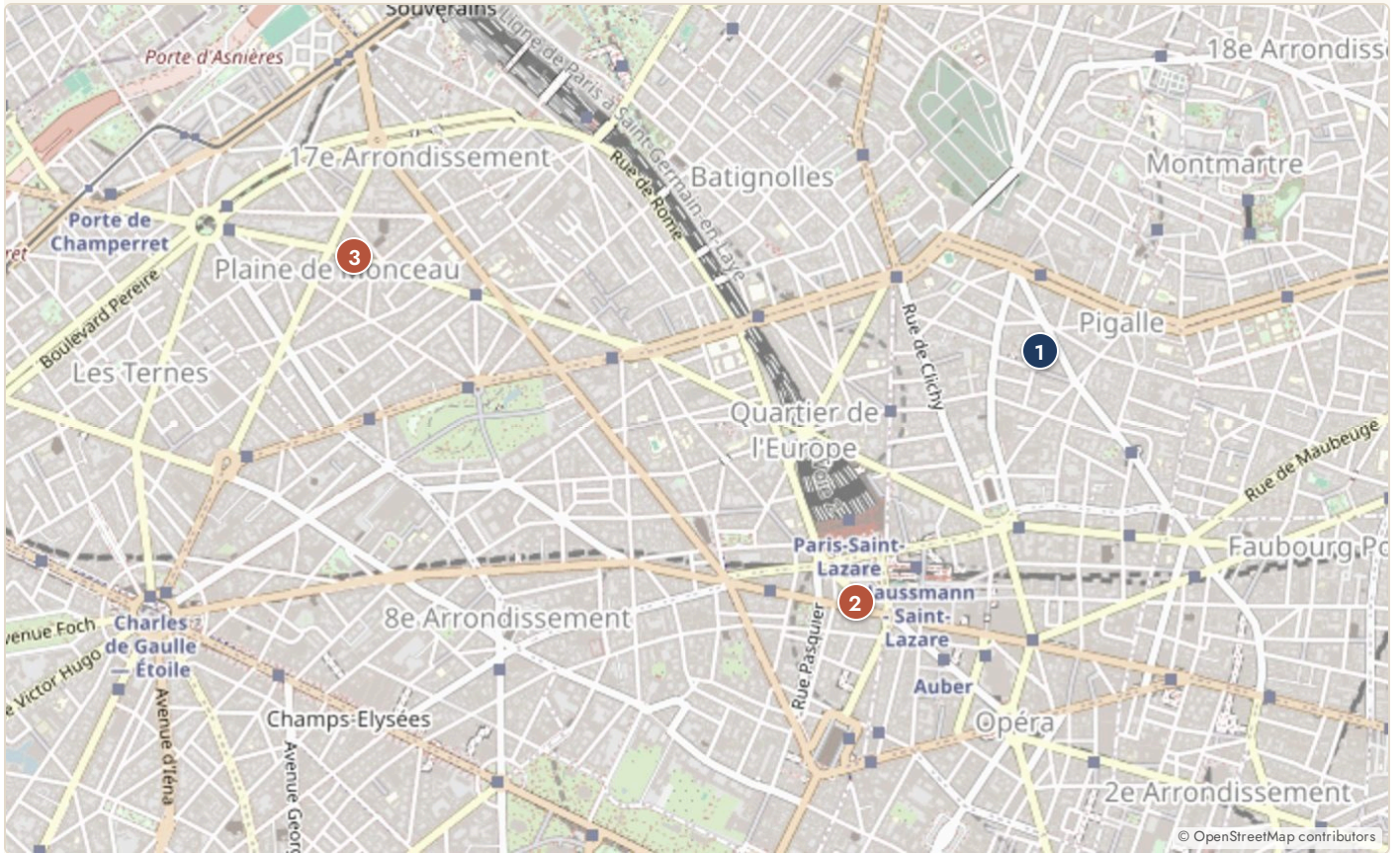
- 6 **Rue du Faubourg Saint-Honoré** — Hermès, Cartier and other heritage names near the Élysée Palace.

WALKS & HIDDEN CORNERS

- 7 **Parc Monceau** — The neighbourhood's real local park — willow-framed pond and colonnade.
- 8 **Champs-Élysées car-free Sunday** — First Sunday of most months, 11 am–5 pm — a very different, local atmosphere.

9e · 17e Opéra, Nouvelle-Athènes & Wagram

A few worth-the-detour spots if a day takes you past the Opéra, Pigalle or the Arc de Triomphe.



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SIGHTS & MUSEUMS

- 1 Musée de la Vie Romantique** NEW — Free museum in a green-shuttered house; its **Rose Bakery** tearoom fills the rose courtyard and glassed-in former studio — cakes, scones, savoury tarts; no ticket or booking needed.



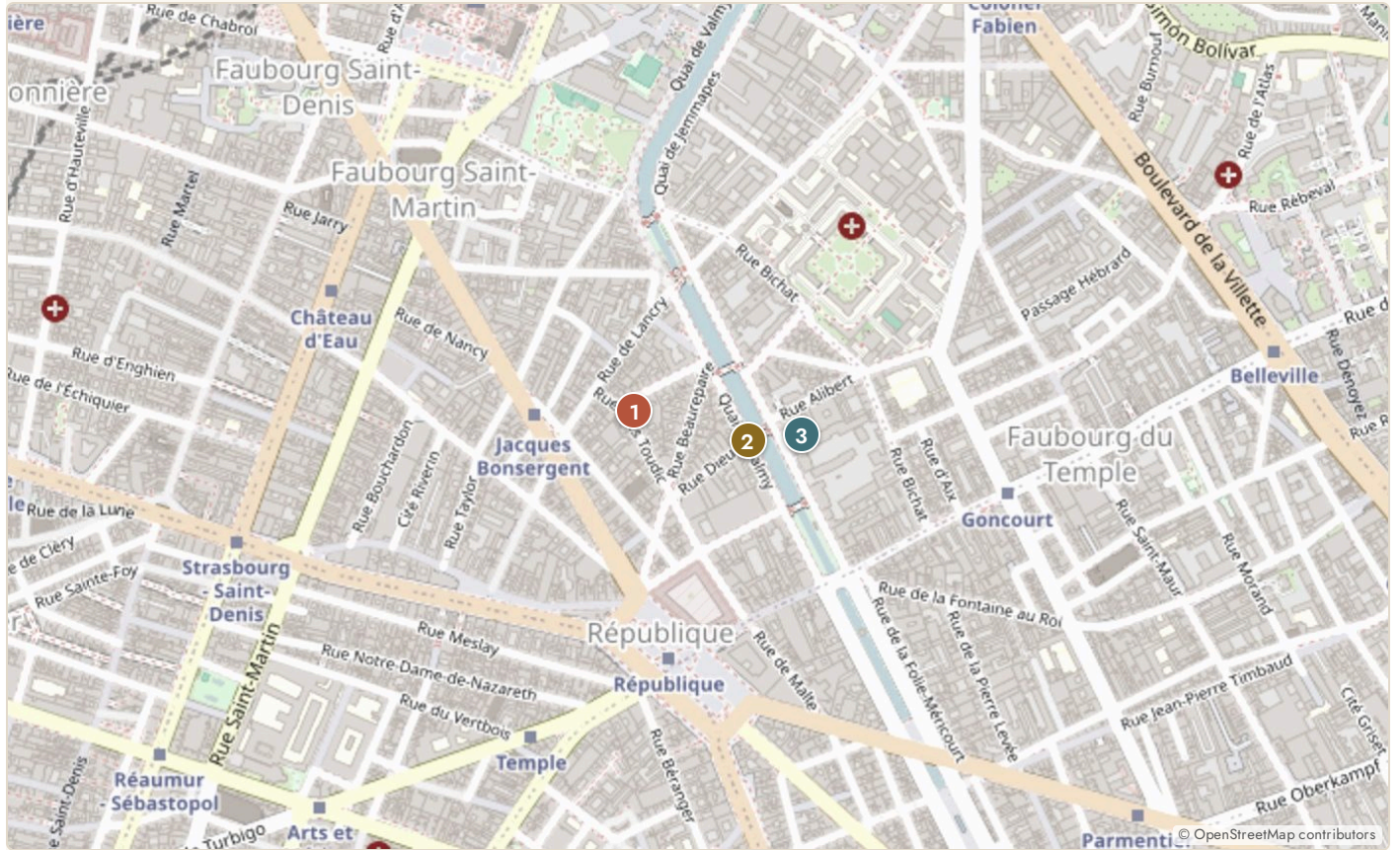
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CAFÉS & SWEETS

- 2 Triadou Haussmann** — Family-run since 1935 near Galeries Lafayette and Opéra Garnier; flowery façade, sunny people-watching terrace.
- 3 La Flamme** — 17th, near the Arc de Triomphe — lush flower façade, playful interior; come for the setting, prices run high.

IOE Canal Saint-Martin

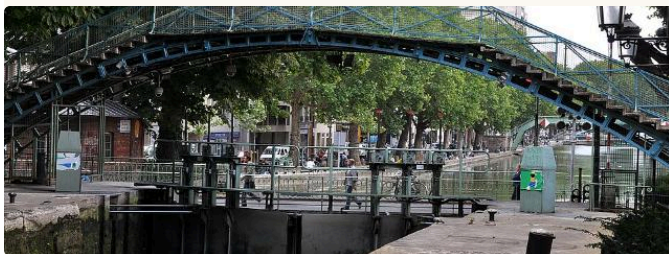
New. Iron footbridges, locks and a slower, creative vibe — young designers, ethical brands, homewares and bookshops, with cafés and wine bars along the water.



● Sights & Museums ● Cafés & Sweets ● Restaurants & Bars ● Markets & Food Shops ● Shopping ● Walks & Hidden Corners ● LGBTQ+-friendly

CAFÉS & SWEETS

- 1 Du Pain et des Idées** — Frequently named one of the best pastry shops in Paris — try an escargot pastry.



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SHOPPING

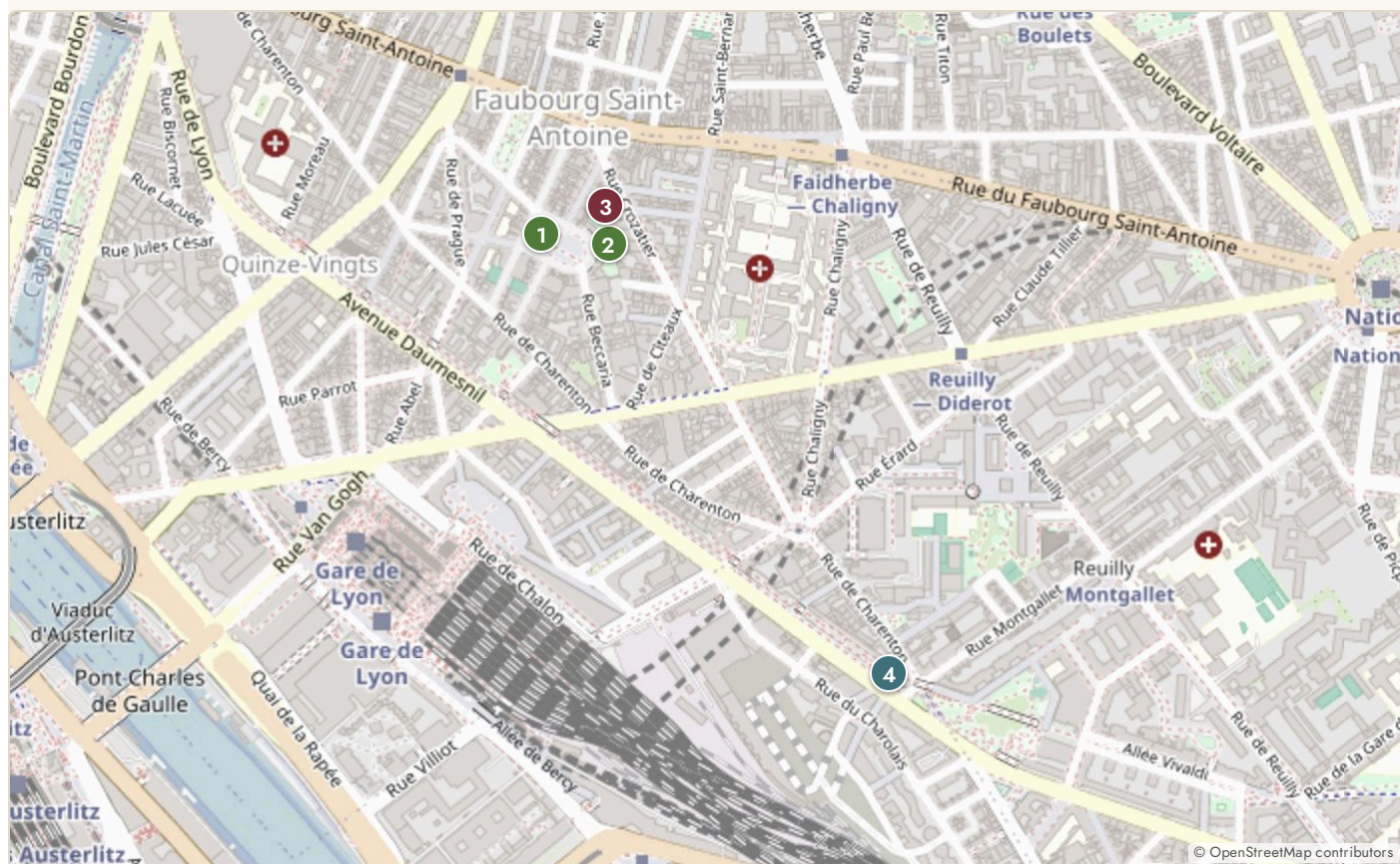
- 2 Canal Saint-Martin shops** — Independent designer fashion, menswear, homewares and books on the streets off Quai de Valmy.

WALKS & HIDDEN CORNERS

- 3 Canal footbridges & locks** — Walk the quays between the arched iron footbridges; best on a weekday afternoon.

I2e Aligre

New. Named No. 30 in Time Out's 2026 “coolest neighbourhoods in the world.” A short walk east of Bastille, once the land of cabinetmakers; the workshops are mostly gone but the village feel stayed — families shop in the morning, all ages fill the bars at night.



● Sights & Museums ● Cafés & Sweets ● Restaurants & Bars ● Markets & Food Shops ● Shopping ● Walks & Hidden Corners ● LGBTQ+-friendly

MARKETS & FOOD SHOPS

- 1 **Marché Beauvau** — The covered market hall, opened in 1779 — ten years before the storming of the Bastille a few blocks away. **Closed Mondays.**
- 2 **Marché d'Aligre & flea stalls** — Outdoor produce stalls plus a small flea market most mornings — old books, dishes, odds and ends.



Mbzt · CC BY 3.0

RESTAURANTS & BARS

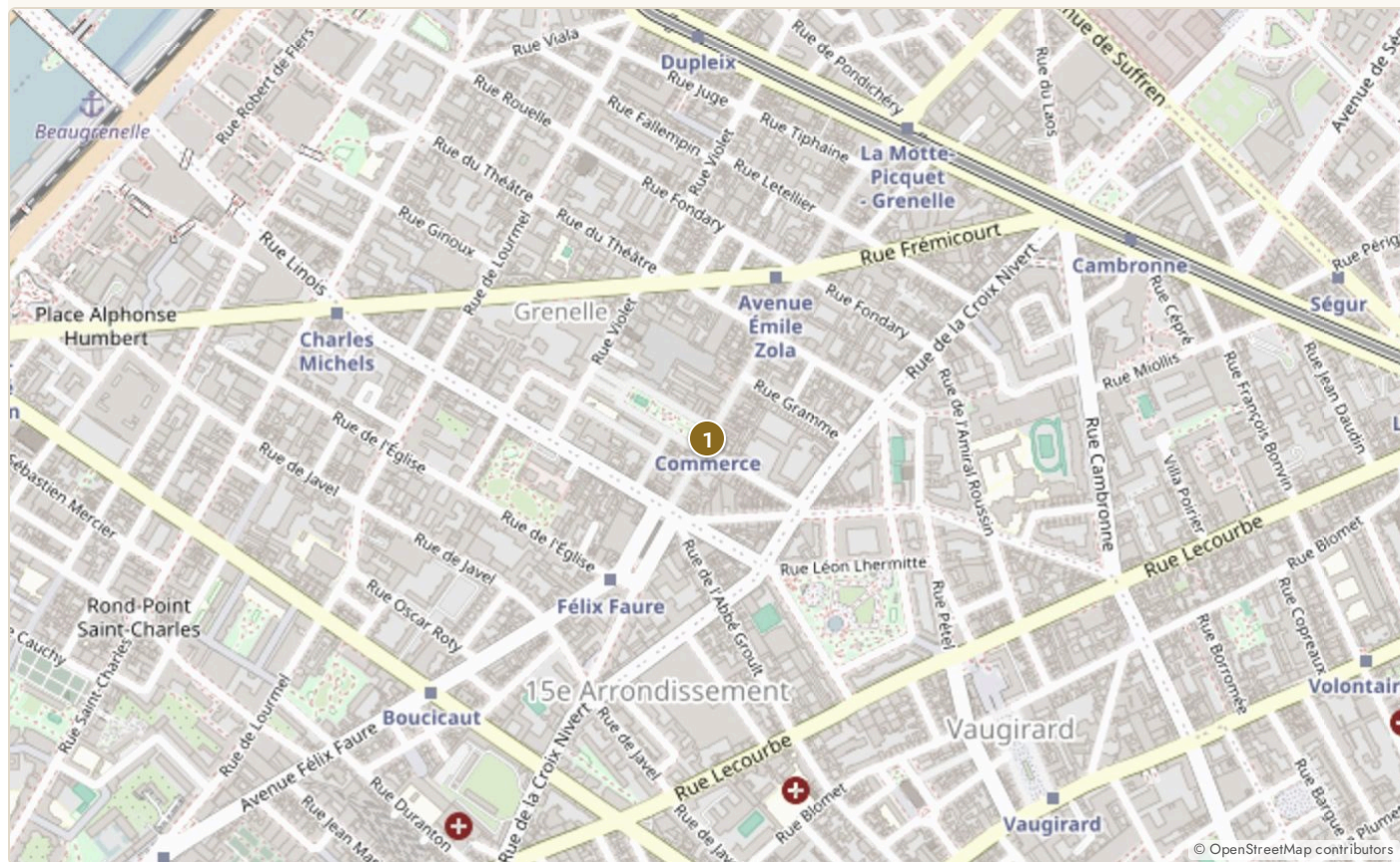
- 3 **Le Baron Rouge** — Time Out's perfect morning: browse the market, then oysters and a glass of white with the regulars here.

WALKS & HIDDEN CORNERS

- 4 **Coulée verte René-Dumont** — The elevated planted promenade (the original “high line”) starts nearby above the Viaduc des Arts.

ARRONDISSEMENT 15^e Rue du Commerce

New. A locals' shopping street that visitors rarely find.



● Sights & Museums ● Cafés & Sweets ● Restaurants & Bars ● Markets & Food Shops ● Shopping ● Walks & Hidden Corners ● LGBTQ+-friendly

SHOPPING

- Rue du Commerce** — 100+ shops over 650 m — French brands (Des Petits Hauts, Zapa), affordable fashion, shoes, home goods, beauty; cafés and bakeries for breaks. Stress-free and crowd-free.

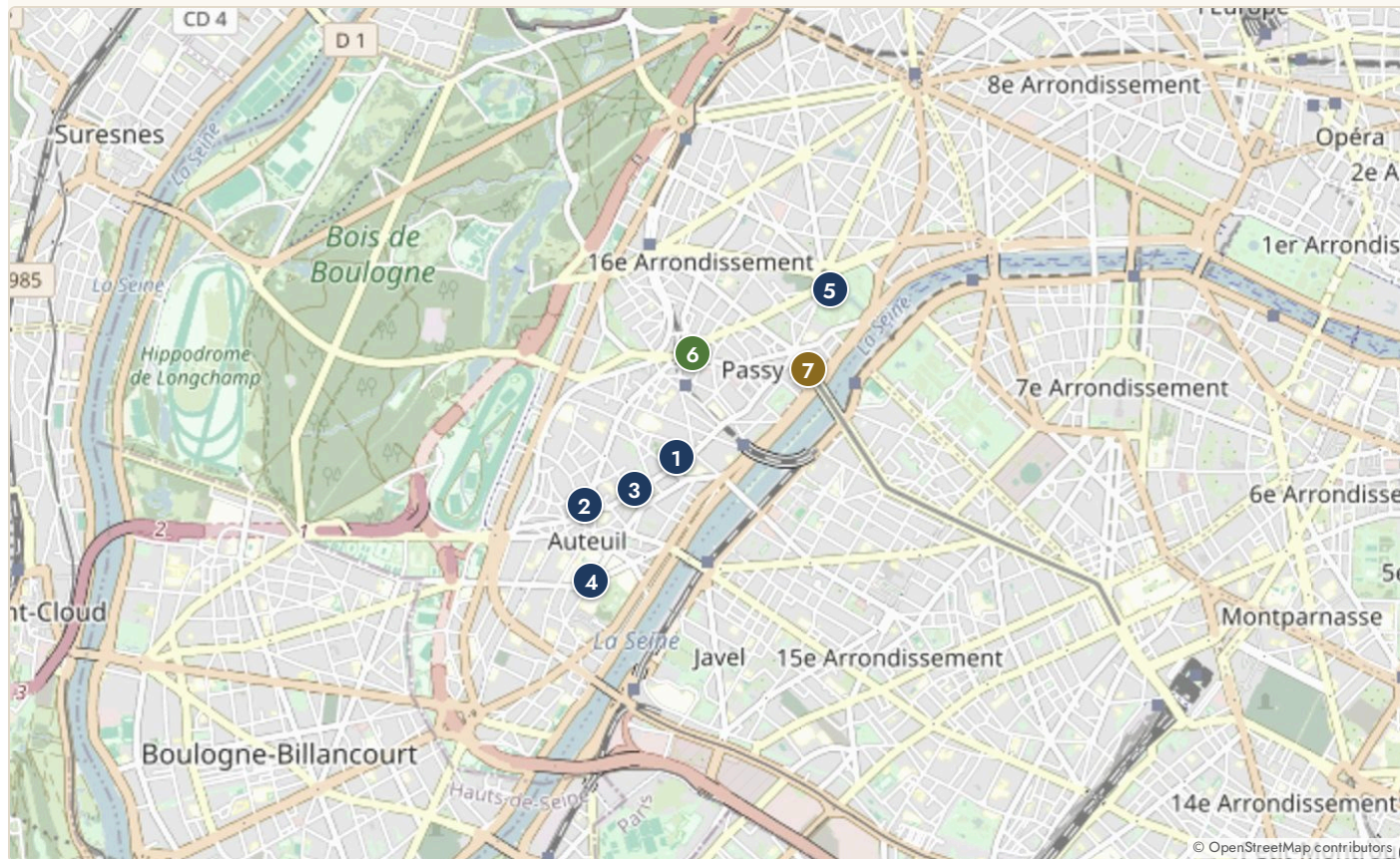


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16e Passy, Auteuil & Trocadéro

ARRONDISSEMENT

Hector Guimard, architect of the curling green Métro entrances (88 of 167 survive), built most of his Art Nouveau houses here. Add Eiffel views and a calm shopping street.



● Sights & Museums ● Cafés & Sweets ● Restaurants & Bars ● Markets & Food Shops ● Shopping ● Walks & Hidden Corners ● LGBTQ+-friendly

SIGHTS & MUSEUMS

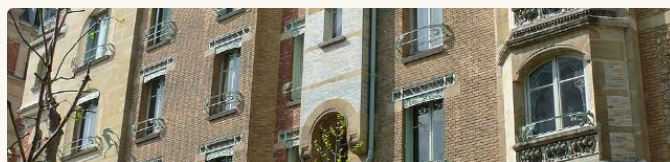
- 1 **Castel Béranger** — Guimard's breakthrough; nearby buildings on Rue Agar too.
- 2 **Hôtel Guimard** — His own house.
- 3 **Hôtel Mezzara** — Set to open as a Guimard museum by the end of 2027.
- 4 **Hôtel Jassedé** — Another Guimard house, further south in Auteuil.
- 5 **Musée de l'Homme – Palais de Chaillot** **NEW** — No ticket needed for its two cafés: casual **Café Lucy** (2nd floor, Eiffel Tower windows) and **Café de l'Homme** (fine dining, tower-facing terrace; book).

MARKETS & FOOD SHOPS

- 6 **La Grande Épicerie Rive Droite** **NEW** — The Right Bank branch of the luxury food hall, with Ya Bayté (Lebanese) and Tafa.

SHOPPING

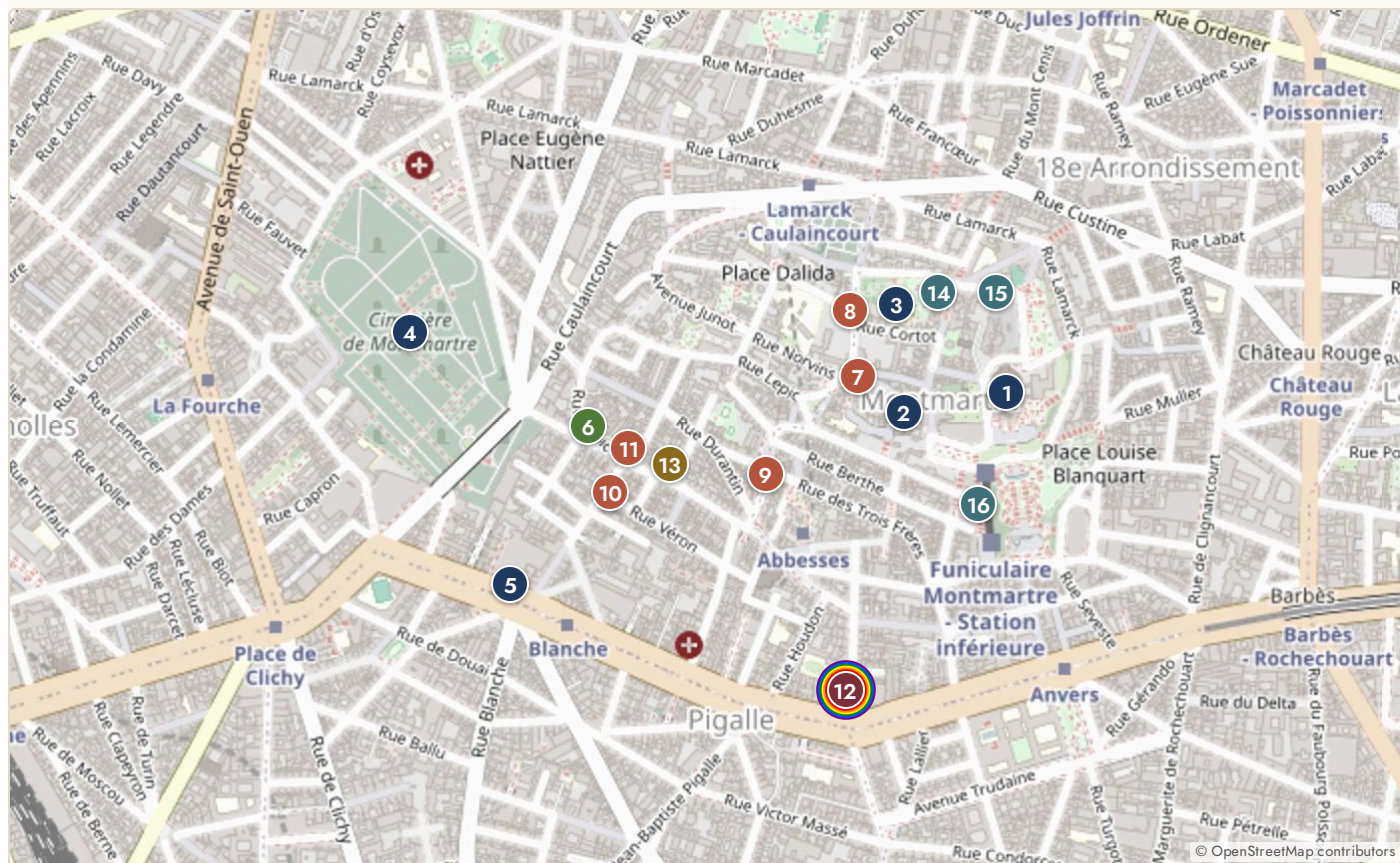
- 7 **Rue de Passy** **NEW** — Flies under the radar: French labels, smart-casual wear, home and kitchen goods; a Galeries Lafayette outpost.



I8e Montmartre

ARRONDISSEMENT

Only part of Paris since 1860 — a hilltop village of windmills and vineyards that still doesn't feel like the rest of the city. Treat it as atmosphere, and go early (by ~9 am) for Sacré-Cœur without crowds.



● Sights & Museums ● Cafés & Sweets ● Restaurants & Bars ● Markets & Food Shops ● Shopping ● Walks & Hidden Corners ● LGBTQ+-friendly

SIGHTS & MUSEUMS

- 1 **Sacré-Cœur** — Climb into the dome for 360° views.
- 2 **Place du Tertre** — Street artists' square.
- 3 **Musée de Montmartre** — In one of the oldest buildings on the hill, with the Renoir Gardens.
- 4 **Cimetière de Montmartre** — Quieter than Père-Lachaise and just as atmospheric.
- 5 **Moulin Rouge** — At the foot of Rue Lepic.



Moonik - CC BY-SA 3.0

MARKETS & FOOD SHOPS

- 6 **Rue Lepic** — Everyday market street — fromagerie, chocolaterie, bakeries — and Café des Deux Moulins (*Amélie*).

CAFÉS & SWEETS

- 7 **Le Consulat** — Classic café frequented by Van Gogh, Monet and Picasso.

- 8 **La Maison Rose** — The famous pink café.
- 9 **Gilles Marchal** — Madeleines.
- 10 **Boris Lumé** — Kouign-amann croissants and baguettes.
- 11 **La Bossue** — Cosy pâtisserie-tearoom with antique cabinets; Saturday brunch buffet (€34.50), warm madeleines.



Giò Terra (Terragio67) · CC BY-SA 4.0

RESTAURANTS & BARS

- 12 **Madame Arthur** LGBTQ+ — Founded in 1946, France's first drag cabaret: French songs reinvented with piano and accordion, then a club. Book ahead.

SHOPPING

- 13 **Rue des Abbesses** NEW — Village-feel shopping: designer and vintage boutiques, jewellery, leather goods, skincare, indie labels, terraces. Start at the Guimard glass-roofed Abbesses Métro entrance.

WALKS & HIDDEN CORNERS

- 14 **Rue de l'Abreuvoir** — One of the prettiest short streets in Paris, from La Maison Rose down to Place Dalida.
- 15 **Vigne du Clos Montmartre** — Last working vineyard in Paris (view from the street).
- 16 **The staircases** — 38 stairways on the hill — Rue Foyatier, Rue du Mont-Cenis and Rue Girardon are the most photogenic.

Boulevard Saint-Germain

Baron Haussmann cut this boulevard through medieval streets for Napoleon III in the mid-1800s; a century later it was the living room of existentialism. Walk it east to west for cafés, bookshops, boutiques and stories.

1 Start: Quai Saint-Bernard / Pont de Sully (5th)

The boulevard's eastern end by the Seine; the Institut du Monde Arabe is right here.

2 Musée de Cluny & the Sorbonne (5th)

Roman baths and the medieval Cluny mansion; the Sorbonne a block south.

3 Carrefour de l'Odéon (6th)

Danton's statue; duck into Cour du Commerce Saint-André and Le Procope.

4 Saint-Germain-des-Prés (6th)

The church (founded 558), then Les Deux Magots and Café de Flore — the existentialists' living rooms.

5 Bookshops & boutiques (6th)

Author events at the bookshops; luxury houses — Sonia Rykiel, Saint Laurent, Ralph Lauren, Louis Vuitton.

6 Rue du Bac to Musée d'Orsay (7th)

Quieter, residential ministries section; a short detour north to Orsay.

7 Finish: Pont de la Concorde (7th)

Cross to Place de la Concorde and the Tuileries/Orangerie.



Les Deux Magots — Cheng-en Cheng from Taichung City, Taiwan · CC BY-SA 2.0



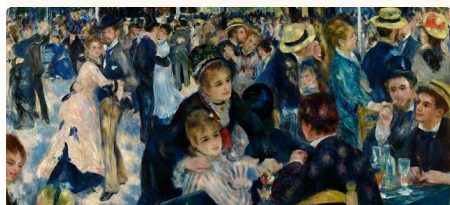
Cour du Commerce Saint-André — Arthur Weidmann from Paris, France · CC BY-SA 2.0



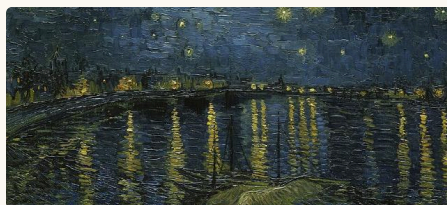
Saint-Sulpice organ — Selbymay · CC BY-SA 3.0

Musée d'Orsay: 15 masterpieces

The world's greatest Impressionist and Post-Impressionist collection. Most of the Impressionists are on the 5th floor, the Realists on the ground floor. Paintings travel and rotate, so check what's hanging. Pair with the Orangerie across the river.



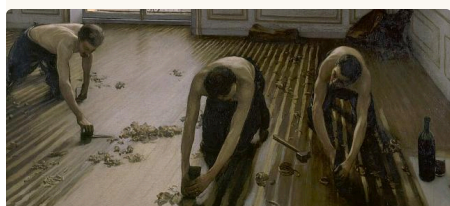
Bal du Moulin de la Galette, Renoir, 1876



Starry Night Over the Rhône, Van Gogh, 1888



Coquelicots (Poppies), Monet, 1873



The Floor Scrapers, Caillebotte, 1875



The Gleaners, Millet, 1857



Café Campana's clock — Phryxian · CC BY-SA 4.0

#	PAINTING	ARTIST	WHY IT MATTERS
1	<i>Bal du Moulin de la Galette</i>	Renoir, 1876	The ultimate Paris snapshot — dappled light on a Montmartre dance.
2	<i>Starry Night Over the Rhône</i>	Van Gogh, 1888	Bold colour and emotional brushwork on the river at Arles.
3	<i>Olympia</i>	Manet, 1863	A modern woman's unflinching gaze; the bridge from Realism to Impressionism.
4	<i>Coquelicots (Poppies)</i>	Monet, 1873	Loose strokes that suggest movement and light.
5	<i>The Artist's Studio</i>	Courbet, 1855	Monumental Realist manifesto with the artist at society's centre.
6	<i>Le Déjeuner sur l'herbe</i>	Manet, 1863	A modern nude in a contemporary setting — broke academic rules.
7	<i>The Ballet Class</i>	Degas, 1874	Candid backstage view of dancers as working people.
8	<i>Young Girls at the Piano</i>	Renoir, 1892	Soft, blended late-career intimacy.
9	<i>Dance in the City / Dance in the Country</i>	Renoir, 1883	A pair: polished urban vs. playful rural romance.
10	<i>London, the Parliament</i>	Monet, 1904	Fog and light over architecture.
11	<i>The Bedroom</i>	Van Gogh, 1889	His refuge in Arles, with tilting perspective and colour.
12	<i>Self-Portrait</i>	Van Gogh, 1889	Composed yet tense; painted at the asylum.
13	<i>The Floor Scrapers</i>	Caillebotte, 1875	Labour raised to fine art with sharp perspective.
14	<i>Arrangement in Grey and Black No. 1</i>	Whistler, 1871	"Whistler's Mother" — composition over story.
15	<i>The Gleaners</i>	Millet, 1857	Rural poverty painted with monumental dignity.

Museum cafés at a glance

Some of the loveliest rooms in Paris for a coffee or lunch are inside museums — and several don't need a ticket.

CAFÉ	MUSEUM	WHAT IT'S LIKE	TICKET NEEDED?
Joli Café	Carnavalet (3e)	Courtyard garden, elevated bistro classics	No — book meals
Café Campana	Orsay (7e)	Behind the giant clock face, 5th floor	Yes
Restaurant du Musée d'Orsay	Orsay (7e)	Gilded Belle Époque dining room	Yes — no reservations
Orsay rooftop terrace	Orsay (7e)	Summer only, drinks with a view	Yes
Café 1902	Petit Palais (8e)	Mosaic-floored gallery around the garden	No
Rose Bakery tearoom	Vie Romantique (9e)	Rose courtyard & glass studio; cakes, tarts	No
Café Lucy	Musée de l'Homme (16e)	Casual Italian bites, Eiffel Tower windows	No
Café de l'Homme	Musée de l'Homme (16e)	Fine dining, terrace facing the tower	No — book



Petit Palais garden, Café 1902 — Petit Palais · CC BY-SA 4.0



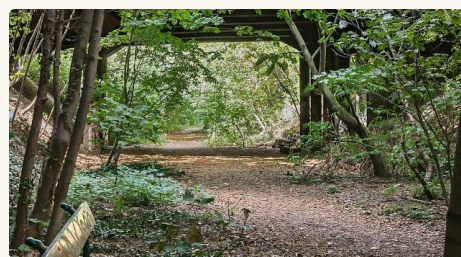
Musée de la Vie romantique — JLPC · CC BY-SA 3.0

WALK · 12E, 14E, 15E, 16E, 20E

The Petite Ceinture

The “little belt” railway was built in the 1850s to move goods and troops around Paris inside the old fortifications. Passenger service ended in 1934 and freight by the 1990s, leaving about 32 km of rail bed circling the city.

Since 2013 the city has opened sections as walking paths in the 12th, 14th, 15th, 16th and 20th, deliberately keeping them wild and overgrown. They're quiet, half-wild corners a few minutes from busy streets. The 16th section pairs well with a Guimard walk through Passy and Auteuil.



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Choosing your home base

5e • Latin Quarter

The most lived-in daily texture: Rue Mouffetard as your market street, cheap bistros, old bookshops.

4e • Marais

Strongest if food and markets matter most: Enfants Rouges, boutique shopping, the islands on your doorstep.

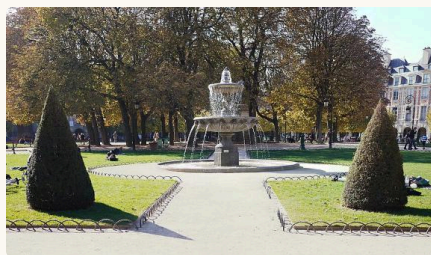
6e • Saint-Germain

Most polished and central: Luxembourg Gardens, the boulevard's cafés and bookshops, the 7th's museums a short walk away.

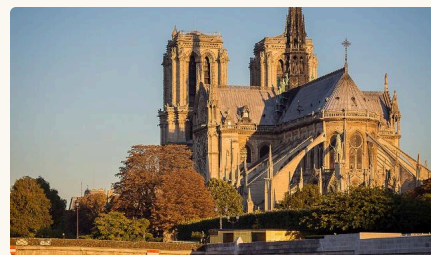
All three are close together, so all of this guide becomes your neighbourhood over a month. The 1st, 2nd, 7th and 8th are a 15–25 minute walk away and Montmartre is a quick Métro ride. **New in this edition:** Aligre (12th) is a 15-minute walk from the Marais across Bastille, and makes a good morning-market ritual.



Bouquinistes, 5e — Benh LIEU SONG · CC BY-SA 3.0



Place des Vosges, 4e — Poulpy · CC BY-SA 3.0

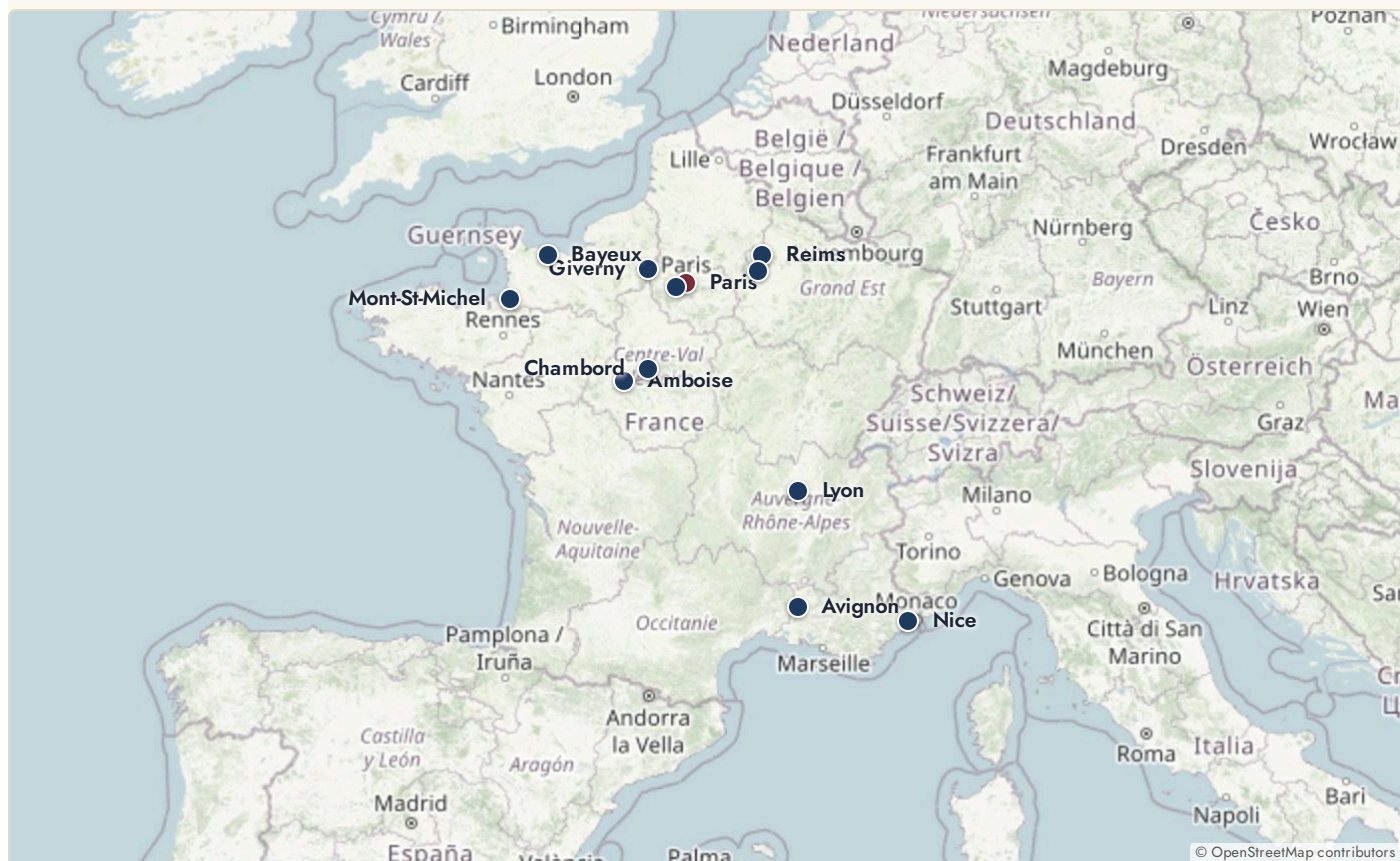


Notre-Dame from the Seine — Antonin Subtil · CC BY-SA 4.0

The rail plan's day trips and extensions (Versailles, Giverny, Champagne, the Loire, Normandy, Provence, the Riviera and Lyon) now have their own chapters, starting on the next page.

Day trips & rail extensions

Everything recommended in the trip plan, from half-day hops on the RER to multi-night TGV extensions. France's fast trains make all of it easy from a Paris base.



DESTINATION	FROM PARIS	BEST AS
Versailles	RER C, ~45 min	Day trip
Giverny	Train ~50 min + shuttle	Day trip (Apr–Oct)
Reims & Épernay	TGV 46 min	Day trip
Loire Valley	TGV 1–2 h	2–3 nights
Normandy & Mont-Saint-Michel	Train 2–3 h	2–3 nights
Lyon	TGV 2 h	Stop en route south
Avignon & Provence	TGV 2 h 37	3 nights
Nice & the Riviera	TGV 5 h 42	3–4 nights

Versailles



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GETTING THERE RER C from the Left Bank (Saint-Michel, Musée d'Orsay, Invalides) to Versailles Château–Rive Gauche, then a 10-minute walk. Uses a regular Île-de-France ticket on your Navigo/app.

A LITTLE HISTORY

Louis XIII's hunting lodge became, under Louis XIV, the most lavish palace in Europe; the court moved here in 1682 and it stayed the seat of royal power until the Revolution marched the royal family back to Paris in October 1789. The Treaty of Versailles ending the First World War was signed in the Hall of Mirrors in 1919.

THINGS TO DO

The palace

The State Apartments, the Hall of Mirrors (357 mirrors facing 17 garden-side windows), the King's and Queen's bedchambers and the Royal Chapel. Timed tickets required.

Trianon & the Queen's Hamlet

The Grand and Petit Trianon and Marie Antoinette's storybook farm village are a 25-minute walk (or the little train) — the calmest part of the estate.

The gardens

Le Nôtre's formal gardens, groves and the Grand Canal — free most days, except on Musical Fountains / Musical Gardens days (weekends and some Tuesdays, spring to autumn). Rent a rowboat on the canal or bikes for the park.

Town of Versailles

The Notre-Dame market (Tue, Fri, Sun mornings, plus covered halls daily) is one of the best in Île-de-France.

Tips: Closed Mondays. Go early on a weekday, or reverse it: gardens and Trianon first, palace after 3 pm. The Paris Museum Pass covers the palace (still reserve a time slot).

Giverny



Pierre André Leclercq · CC BY-SA 4.0



Luc Morel · CC BY-SA 3.0

GETTING THERE Train from Gare Saint-Lazare to Vernon-Giverny (about 45–50 min), then the shuttle, bus, bike rental or a 5 km riverside walk to the village.

A LITTLE HISTORY

Claude Monet rented a pink farmhouse here in 1883, bought it in 1890 and spent 43 years making the garden his subject — diverting a stream to create the water garden with its Japanese bridge and the lilies he painted some 250 times. His final Water Lilies are the ones in the Orangerie, which makes this the perfect companion to *Monet, Painting Time* in the Monet centenary year.

THINGS TO DO

Fondation Claude Monet

The house (yellow dining room, his Japanese prints) and the Clos Normand flower garden, then under the road to the water garden, bridge and lily pond.

The village

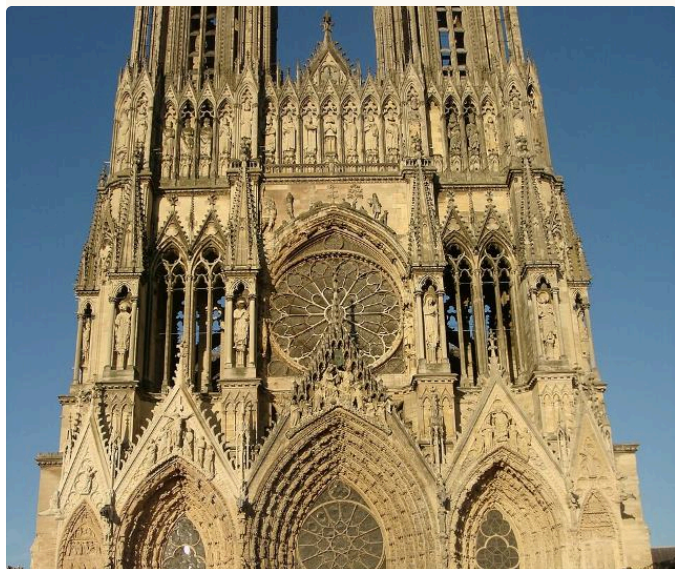
Monet's grave at the Église Sainte-Radegonde, and lunch at the historic Hôtel Baudy, where American painters stayed.

Musée des Impressionnismes

A short walk away, with changing exhibitions and its own garden.

Tips: The gardens are open roughly **April 1 to November 1** only — check the season for your dates. Book a timed ticket; go at opening or late afternoon. Spring (tulips, wisteria) and June (water lilies, roses) are the peaks.

Reims & Épernay



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Michal Osmenda from Brussels, Belgium · CC BY 2.0

GETTING THERE TGV from Gare de l'Est to Reims (46 min). Épernay, on the Avenue de Champagne, is 25 minutes further by regional train — doable in the same day.

A LITTLE HISTORY

Clovis, king of the Franks, was baptised in Reims around 496, and for nearly a thousand years French kings were crowned in its cathedral — Joan of Arc stood beside Charles VII here in 1429. The cathedral was badly shelled in the First World War and restored with Rockefeller help; it now holds Chagall windows alongside the medieval glass. Beneath the city run over 200 km of Roman-era chalk quarries turned Champagne cellars.

THINGS TO DO

Notre-Dame de Reims

Gothic coronation cathedral with 2,300 statues, including the “Smiling Angel,” and Chagall’s 1974 windows. Next door, the Palais du Tau holds the coronation treasures.

Épernay

The Avenue de Champagne, lined with the great houses (Moët & Chandon, Perrier-Jouët, Pol Roger), with 110 km of cellars beneath it; tasting bars all along.

Champagne houses

Cellar tours with tasting at Taittinger, Veuve Clicquot, Pommery, Ruinart (the oldest house, 1729) or Mumm — book ahead, popular slots sell out.

Basilique Saint-Remi

Romanesque abbey church with the tomb of Saint Remi, who baptised Clovis — quieter than the cathedral.

Tips: Book cellar tours well in advance and bring a layer — the crayères stay around 10–12°C year-round. Reims and the Champagne hillsides are a UNESCO World Heritage site.

Loire Valley



Benh LIEU SONG · CC BY-SA 3.0



It is a derivative work of Rasmit's photo. · GFDL

GETTING THERE TGV from Montparnasse to Saint-Pierre-des-Corps/Tours, or trains to Amboise and Blois. Base in Amboise (smaller, prettier) or Tours (more amenities); châteaux by bike, car or minibus tour.

A LITTLE HISTORY

The “Garden of France” became the playground of the Renaissance kings in the 1500s: François I brought Leonardo da Vinci to Amboise in 1516, and the court moved between dozens of châteaux along the river. The central Loire Valley is a UNESCO World Heritage cultural landscape.

THINGS TO DO

Château de Chambord

François I's vast hunting palace with a double-helix staircase often attributed to Leonardo, 426 rooms and a rooftop “village” of chimneys and turrets.

Amboise & Clos Lucé

The royal château, where Leonardo is buried in the Chapelle Saint-Hubert, and Clos Lucé, his last home, with models of his inventions in the park.

Château de Chenonceau

The “ladies' château” arching across the River Cher, shaped by Diane de Poitiers and Catherine de' Medici; used as a crossing point out of occupied France in WWII.

Wine & villages

Vouvray and Montlouis chenin blancs in cave cellars cut into the tuffeau; Saturday market in Tours; bike the Loire à Vélo route.

Tips: Don't rush it as a day trip — two nights lets you see three châteaux without a dash. Chenonceau is busiest late morning; go at opening.

Normandy & Mont-Saint-Michel



Giladtop · CC BY-SA 4.0



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GETTING THERE Train from Paris Saint-Lazare to Bayeux (via Caen). D-Day beaches with a guided minibus tour; Mont-Saint-Michel by bus or tour from Bayeux or via Rennes and Pontorson.

A LITTLE HISTORY

William, Duke of Normandy, sailed from here to conquer England in 1066 — the Bayeux Tapestry tells the story in 70 metres of embroidery. On 6 June 1944 Allied forces landed on five beaches along this coast. Mont-Saint-Michel's abbey has crowned its tidal island since the 10th century; the bay has some of the largest tides in Europe.

THINGS TO DO

Bayeux

The Gothic cathedral and a medieval centre spared in 1944. **Note:** the Tapestry itself is on loan to the British Museum in London from 10 Sept 2026 to 11 July 2027 while its Bayeux museum is rebuilt, so if you travel in that window, see it in London on the Eurostar extension instead.

Mont-Saint-Michel

Climb the Grande Rue to the abbey and cloister; walk out on the sands only with a licensed guide. Stay the night on or near the Mount to see it after the day crowds leave.

D-Day beaches

Omaha Beach and the Normandy American Cemetery at Colleville-sur-Mer, Pointe du Hoc, Arromanches' Mulberry harbour remains, and Juno Beach Centre — the Canadian landing museum at Courseulles-sur-Mer.

Tastes

Cider and calvados, Camembert and Pont-l'Évêque, and omelettes at La Mère Poulard on the Mount.

Tips: Check tide tables before you pick the Mont-Saint-Michel day — the big spring tides are spectacular. The Juno Beach Centre is a must for Canadians.

Avignon & Provence



Txllxt Txllxt · CC BY-SA 4.0



Chimigi · CC BY-SA 2.0 fr

GETTING THERE Direct TGV from Gare de Lyon to Avignon TGV, then the shuttle train into town. Stay inside the walls; day trips by train to Arles, Aix, Nîmes, or by car/tour to the Luberon villages.

A LITTLE HISTORY

Seven popes reigned from Avignon between 1309 and 1377, building the largest Gothic palace in Europe; rival “antipopes” stayed on until 1403. The half-bridge of Saint-Bénézet, famous from the nursery song, was abandoned in the 1600s after repeated floods. The historic centre is UNESCO-listed.

THINGS TO DO

Palais des Papes

The vast papal palace; the HistoPad tablet reconstructs the lost frescoes and furnishings.

Les Halles d'Avignon

Covered market with a living plant wall — Provençal olives, cheeses, and a Saturday cooking demo.

Pont Saint-Bénézet

Walk out on the four remaining arches; the view is best from the Rocher des Doms garden above.

Day trips

Pont du Gard Roman aqueduct; Arles's Roman arena and Van Gogh sites; Aix-en-Provence's markets and Cours Mirabeau; the Luberon's Gordes and Roussillon; Châteauneuf-du-Pape wine.

Tips: July brings the huge Festival d'Avignon — book early or avoid. Lavender peaks late June to mid-July.

Nice & the Riviera



W. M. Connolley · CC BY-SA 3.0



Cayambe · CC BY-SA 3.0

GETTING THERE TGV direct from Paris Gare de Lyon or on from Avignon. Local trains and the €2.50 bus network reach Èze, Monaco, Villefranche, Antibes and Cannes.

A LITTLE HISTORY

Nice was part of the House of Savoy's territory for most of five centuries and only became French in 1860, which is why the old town still feels Italian. English aristocrats wintering here paid for the seafront path that became the Promenade des Anglais; Matisse and Chagall both made the city home.

THINGS TO DO

Vieux Nice & Cours Saleya

Flower and food market (fish and flowers daily except Monday, antiques on Mondays), socca from a street stall, Baroque chapels.

Museums

Musée Matisse and the Marc Chagall National Museum in Cimiez; the Musée d'Art Moderne (MAMAC).

Promenade des Anglais & Castle Hill

7 km seafront walk; climb or take the lift up Colline du Château for the classic view over the Baie des Anges.

Day trips

Perched Èze and its exotic garden; Monaco's Rock and casino; Villefranche's bay; Antibes and the Picasso Museum; Saint-Paul-de-Vence and the Fondation Maeght.

Tips: Take the train home: the Nice–Paris TGV is a scenic way to end the trip, running along the coast before turning north.

Lyon

Les Halles de Lyon – Paul Bocuse NEW

102 Cours Lafayette, Lyon (Part-Dieu, 5 min from the station) — 2 h by TGV from Paris and right on the line to Avignon, so an easy stop on the Provence leg. 48 vendors on 3 floors: cheesemongers Mère Richard, Fromagerie Mons and Beillevaire; chocolatier Maison Sève; oysters, truffles, Bresse poultry; lunch at Chez Léon or Le Fer à Cheval. Vendors Tue–Sat 7 am–7 pm (bars/restaurants to 10:30 pm), Sun 7 am–1 pm; Mondays oysters only.

France's gastronomic capital sits right on the TGV line to Avignon, so a night here (or a long lunch between trains) breaks up the journey south. Beyond the market: the Roman theatres and basilica on Fourvière hill, the Renaissance lanes and hidden *traboules* of Vieux Lyon, and a proper *bouchon* dinner.



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Sources & credits

- Life in Rural France — 7 Fun Places to Shop in Paris
- Life in Rural France — Boulevard Saint-Germain
- Life in Rural France — Which Arrondissement to Stay In
- Life in Rural France — Hector Guimard
- France Adventurer — 15 Musée d'Orsay Masterpieces
- France Adventurer — Museum Cafés in Paris
- France Adventurer — Arrondissement guides (1st–8th, Marais, Latin Quarter, Montmartre)
- France Adventurer — 8 Unusual Paris Museums
- City or City — La Grande Épicerie (7e)
- Musée de l'Orangerie — Monet, Painting Time
- Salut from Paris — How to Use the Paris Metro 2026
- This Is Lyon — Les Halles de Lyon Paul Bocuse
- Prepare Travel Plans — Special Paris Cafés
- Prepare Travel Plans — Best of the Latin Quarter
- Time Out — World's Coolest Neighbourhoods 2026 (Aligre, No. 30)
- Paris je t'aime — The LGBT+ Marais
- Inter-LGBT — Marche des Fiertés 2026 (3 October)
- Centre LGBTQI+ de Paris et d'Île-de-France
- Travel Gay / The Gay Passport — Paris gay bars 2026
- Sortir à Paris — Le Tango
- Rosa Bonheur sur Seine

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